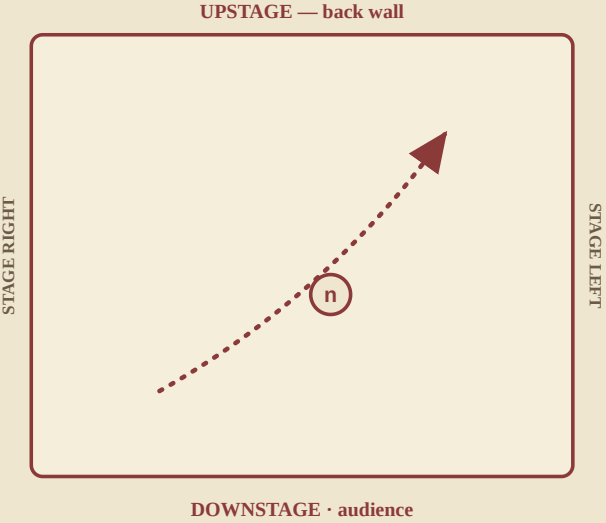


# Movement & Blocking Maps

Top-down staging plans — *Six Characters in Search of an Author* · Village Players, Lausanne · dir. Kiarash Jamshidi



Every plan is seen from above. The audience sits at the bottom edge.

## THE COMPANY ON STAGE

- F** The Father
- M** The Mother
- SD** The Step-Daughter
- S** The Son
- MG** The Manager
- P1** Player 1
- P2** Player 2
- P3** Player 3
- MP** Madame Pace
- PN** Pianist

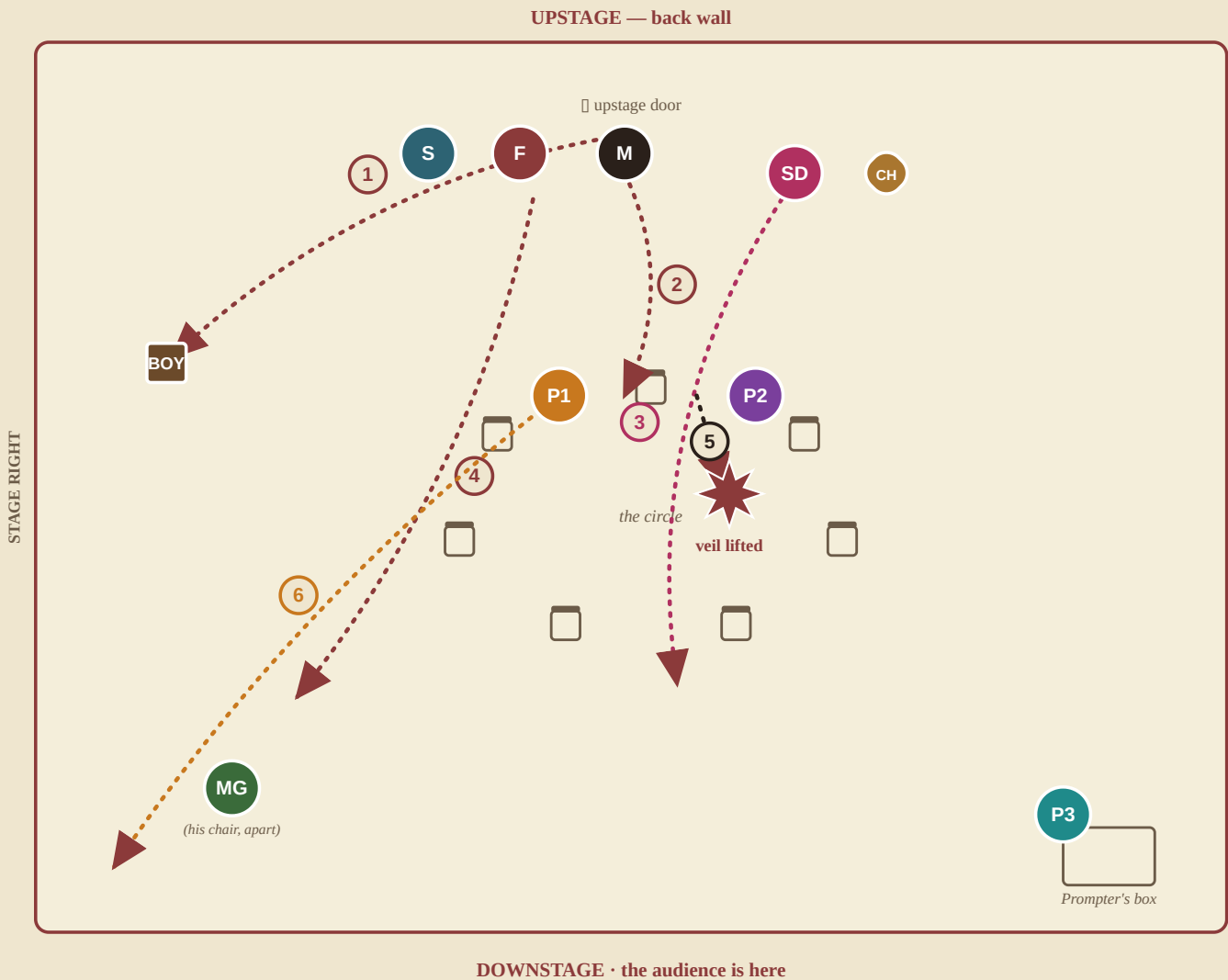
## THE TWO STAGE OBJECTS

- BOY** Boy-chair (the Boy)
  - CH** Child-bundle (the Child)
- SYMBOLS**
- a movement, in order
  - a chair (Act One circle)
  - the gunshot / a sudden event
  - the “shower” light column (Act Two)

Read each act's plan with its numbered key on the right; the per-character journey is the last page.

# Act One — The Family

A bare stage, a circle of chairs. The rehearsal is interrupted; the Six walk in.

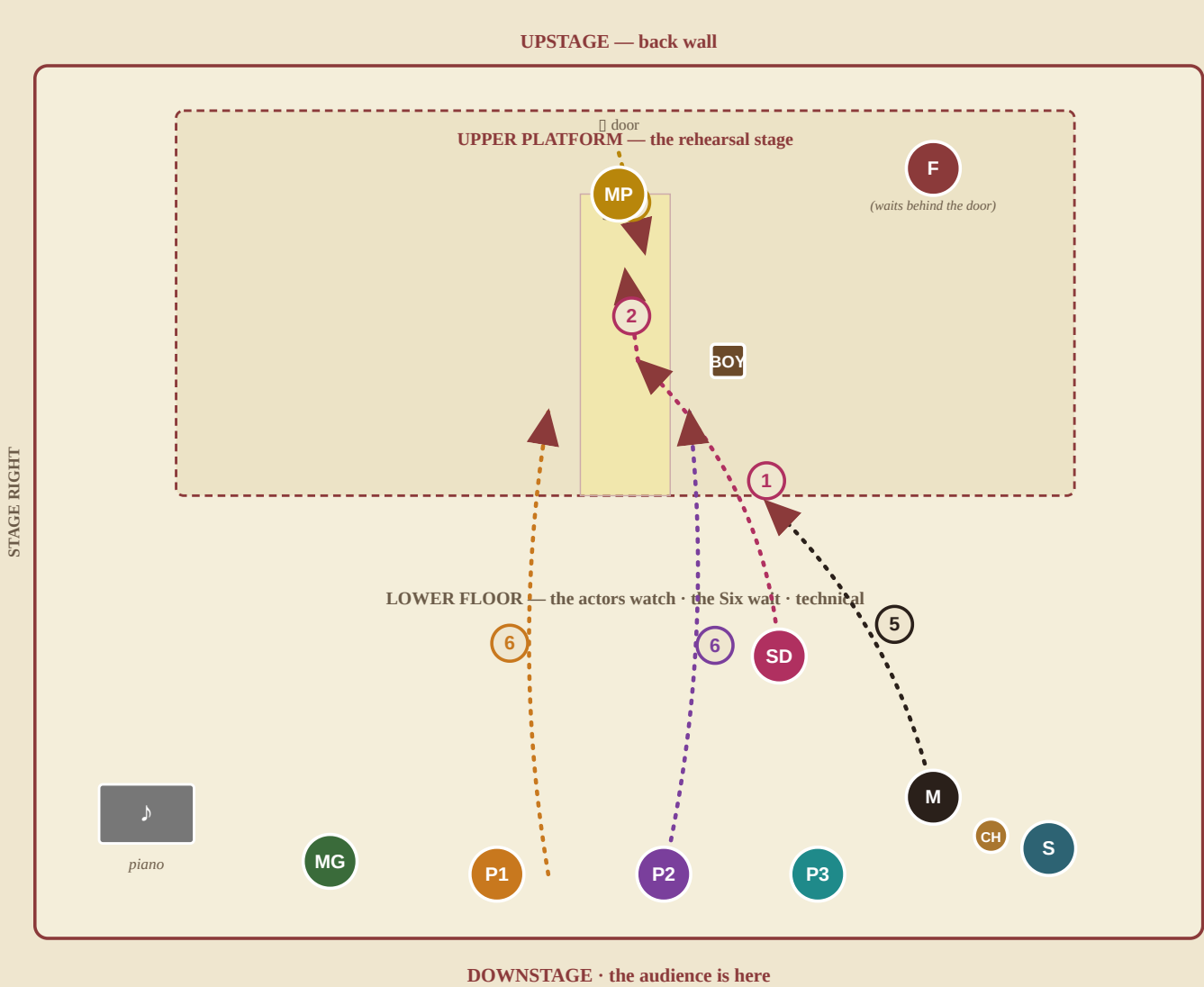


## Movement key

- 1 The Door-keeper carries the Boy-chair in from the upstage door and sets it at the stage-right edge.
- 2 The Six enter from the upstage door in a tenuous light and advance to centre.
- 3 The Step-Daughter comes downstage with the Child-bundle — sings and dances, then taunts the Father.
- 4 The Father crosses to the Manager (at his chair, apart) and pleads to be staged.
- 5 The Mother faints centre; the Father lifts her veil against her will.
- 6 The company recedes to the wings and becomes the on-stage audience; the bargain — light drifts amber to deep red.

# Act Two — The Theatre

Two levels. Performing is up; watching is down. The line between them is the platform's edge.

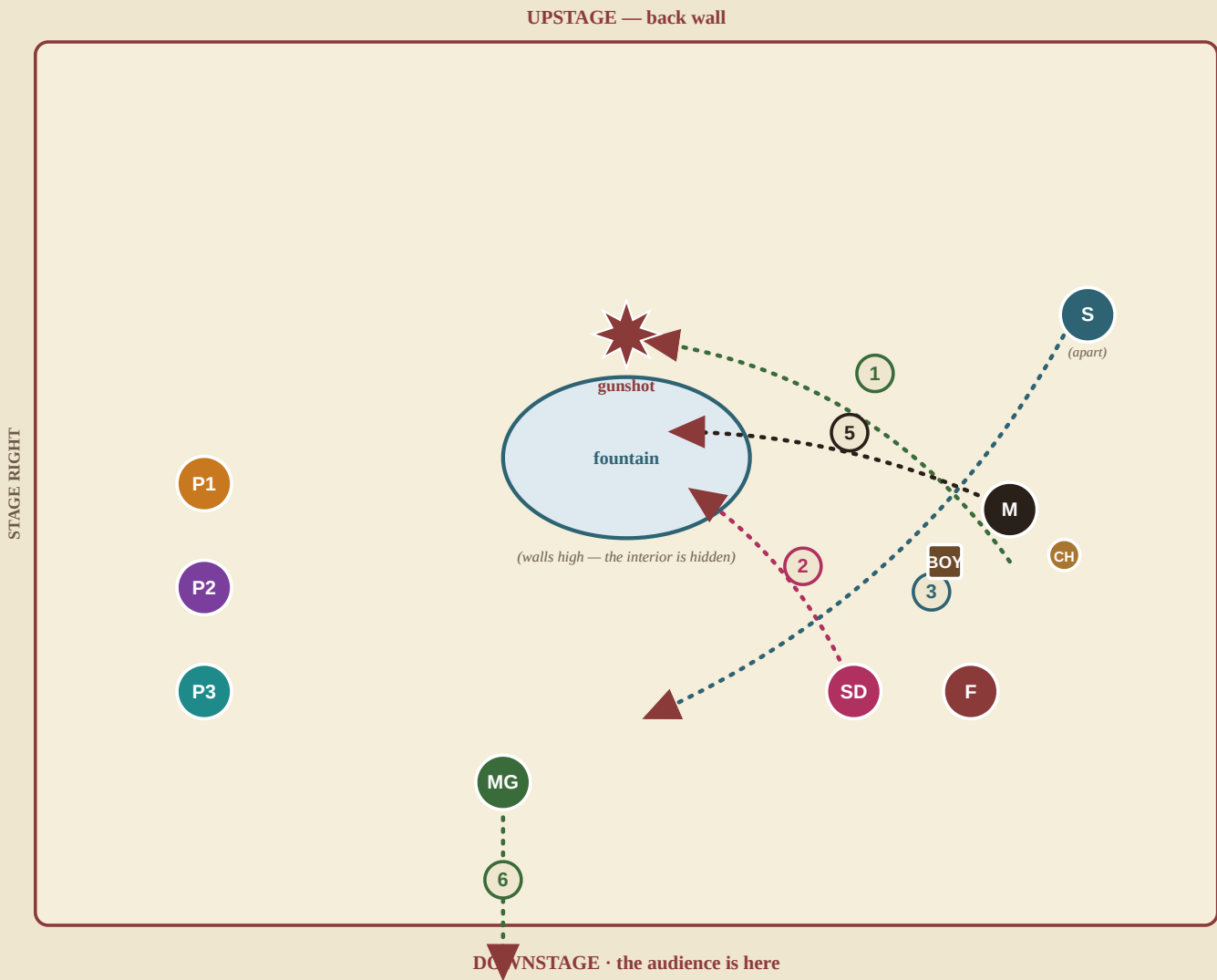


## Movement key

- 1 The Step-Daughter erupts from the lower floor up onto the platform, dragging the Boy-chair, carrying the Child-bundle.
- 2 She steps into the shower for her solo monologue, and takes the revolver from the coat on the Boy-chair.
- 3 Conjured: the upstage door opens and Madame Pace enters onto the platform, into the shower — the shop scene.
- 4 The Father waits behind the upstage door, ready to enter the scene on cue.
- 5 The Mother, on the lower floor, erupts upward at Madame Pace — “You old devil!” — her voice crossing up.
- 6 The Leading Lady and Leading Man climb up to replay the scene (the doubled scene); the Mother is forced to watch; the Machinist drops the curtain by accident.

# Act Three — The Question

A bare stage; one fountain basin. Family stage-right, the company stage-left, the Manager centre.



## Movement key

- 1 The Manager picks up the Boy-chair himself and carries it behind the fountain — the moment he stops being audience and becomes accessory.
- 2 The Step-Daughter crosses to the basin, bends over it, and lowers the Child-bundle into the water.
- 3 The Son comes downstage-centre to narrate the drowning he could not stop — his one continuous speech.
- 4 Blackout. A real gunshot from behind the basin, where the Boy-chair is.
- 5 The Mother rises and reaches — first for the Child-bundle in the basin, then for the Boy-chair behind it — and cannot hold both.
- 6 The Manager looks at the empty Boy-chair, says “To hell with it all,” and walks out the way a man leaves a theatre.

# Where everyone goes — the journey in one view

| CHARACTER         | ACT ONE — THE FAMILY                                                                         | ACT TWO — THE THEATRE                                                                            | ACT THREE — THE QUESTION                                                                               |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Father        | Enters with the Six (upstage); crosses to plead with the Manager; lifts the Mother's veil.   | On the lower floor; waits behind the upstage door of the platform to play the shop scene.        | Seated right-front; argues the reality debate centre; pinned, ends in stillness.                       |
| The Mother        | Enters with the Six; faints centre; veil lifted against her will.                            | On the lower floor; erupts upward at Madame Pace; forced to watch the doubled scene.             | Seated right with both children; rises and reaches for Child-bundle then Boy-chair — cannot hold both. |
| The Step-Daughter | Enters with the Child-bundle; comes downstage to sing and taunt; drives the exposure.        | Erupts up onto the platform; solo in the shower; plays the shop scene with Madame Pace.          | Crosses to the basin, lowers the Child-bundle in; then runs, and is gone.                              |
| The Son           | Enters with the Six; stays at the edge, refusing.                                            | On the lower floor, apart; will not go up.                                                       | Isolated stage-right; comes downstage to narrate the drowning — his one continuous speech.             |
| The Manager       | At his own chair, apart; receives the Father; runs the room.                                 | On the lower floor; casts and directs the doubled scene from below.                              | Centre, standing; picks up the Boy-chair and sets it behind the fountain; then walks out.              |
| Player 1          | Leading Man in the chair circle; Door-keeper carries in the Boy-chair; recedes to the wings. | Climbs to the platform as the Leading Man in the doubled scene; the Machinist drops the curtain. | Seated stage-left with the company; watches.                                                           |
| Player 2          | Leading Lady in the circle; gives her hat; recedes to the wings.                             | Climbs to the platform as the Leading Lady (doubled scene); walks off, offended.                 | Seated stage-left; watches.                                                                            |
| Player 3          | Youngest; near the Prompter's box; recedes to the wings with the company.                    | On the lower floor; the company's witness as the scene turns.                                    | Seated stage-left; the audience's mirror.                                                              |
| Madame Pace       | — (not yet present).                                                                         | Conjured through the upstage door of the platform; into the shower; plays the shop, then exits.  | — (her scene is over).                                                                                 |
| Boy-chair         | Carried in by the Door-keeper; set at the stage-right edge.                                  | Dragged up onto the platform; the revolver taken from its coat.                                  | Carried by the Manager behind the fountain; the gunshot comes from there.                              |
| Child-bundle      | Carried on by the Step-Daughter; held centre.                                                | In the Step-Daughter's arms through the monologue and the shop.                                  | Lowered into the fountain basin; the drowning is hidden by its walls.                                  |